

Ἡρώδας ὁ Μιμογράφος

Mimiamb of Herodas the Mimiamb Poet

eul_aid: isy

Period: Ἑλληνιστική [Hellenistic](#)
Dialect: Ἴωνική Ἰαμβική [Ionic Iambic](#)
Domain: Δρᾶμα [Drama](#)
Format: Ἑμμετρος [Verse](#)

Herodas, also spelled Herondas, was a Hellenistic Greek poet of the 3rd century BCE. Little is known of his life, though he is sometimes associated with the island of Cos, and he may have lived in Alexandria under Ptolemy II Philadelphus.

His work was rediscovered through a papyrus manuscript found at El-Faiyûm, Egypt in the late 19th century. He is known exclusively for his Mimiambi, short dramatic mimes written in sczons, or limping iambics. A single papyrus, British Library Papyrus 135, preserves eight complete poems and a fragment of a ninth. These include "The Procureess," "The Brothel-Keeper," "The Schoolmaster," "Women Sacrificing to Asclepius," "The Jealous Woman," "Private Conversation," "The Shoemaker," and "The Dream."

Herodas is significant as the only Hellenistic poet whose Mimiambi survive substantially intact. His work offers a vivid, often coarse, glimpse into the everyday life of ordinary Hellenistic people. He employs a literary Ionic dialect imitating the archaic iambics of Hipponax, blending an archaic style with contemporary popular mime.

Works (1)

- [Μιμίαμβοι](#) · [Mimiamb](#) · 208 passages